

CSEN 296B-2 | Week 2.1 Lab

Definition of Done for AstraNotes

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1. Definition of Done

A task, feature, or artifact in AstraNotes is considered done only when every one of the following conditions is true.

Traceable to an objective. The work maps directly to a backlog item, course requirement, or documented project goal. If I cannot point to the specific objective it serves, it is not done.

Explainable by me. I can walk through the logic, design choice, or implementation without referencing the original AI prompt. If I need the prompt to explain it, I do not understand it well enough to ship it.

Checked for quality and realism. The code compiles, passes lint and type checks, and behaves as expected in a local dev environment. Documentation reads clearly and does not contain hallucinated references or placeholder content that was never filled in.

Tested or validated. For code changes, at minimum a manual smoke test of the affected feature has been performed. For non-code artifacts like requirements or design docs, a self-review pass has confirmed internal consistency and alignment with the current AstraNotes architecture.

Security and privacy considered. Any feature that touches user data has been reviewed against Supabase Row Level Security policies. No API keys, secrets, or personally identifiable information have been hardcoded or exposed. If the task has no security surface, I have consciously confirmed that rather than simply ignoring the question.

Ready to build on. The work is organized, committed to the correct branch, and documented well enough that I could pick it up a week later or hand it to another developer without a lengthy explanation. File names, component structure, and commit messages follow the conventions already established in the repo.

Worth defending. I am willing to present this work in a lab review or class demo and explain why it deserves to move forward. If I would feel the need to add caveats or apologies, it is not done.

Testing Against Current Work

I applied this checklist to my most recent AstraNotes lab submission, which involved setting up the initial Supabase schema and authentication flow. The code worked, but I realized I had not explicitly verified the Row Level Security policies against my intended access patterns. Under this Definition of Done, that submission would not have passed the security consideration check. Catching that gap now is exactly the kind of issue this checklist is designed to surface before it compounds.

2. Reflection

The Definition of Done gives me a concrete stopping rule instead of relying on a vague sense that something feels finished. The most valuable criterion for my workflow is the explainability check. AI-generated code can look polished and pass linting while still containing logic I do not fully understand. Requiring myself to explain every piece before marking it done adds a small amount of time per task but should prevent the kind of compounding confusion where I build three features on top of code I never really understood. Combined with the Working Agreement, these two artifacts create a lightweight governance layer that treats AI collaboration as a system of work rather than just a faster way to produce output.